POLICY AS CODE / AUTOMATED COMPLIANCE

COMPLIANCE AS CODE

Manual compliance audits are slow, error-prone, and don't scale. When compliance controls are codified as policy, they run automatically on every deployment. Evidence is generated continuously as a by-product of normal operations — not assembled under pressure before an audit.

KEY BENEFITS

- ✓ Reduces audit preparation from weeks to hours by generating evidence continuously
- ✓ Prevents non-compliant configurations from ever reaching production
- ✓ Scales compliance across hundreds of services without manual review
- ✓ Creates an immutable, timestamped trail of every compliance check and outcome

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

HashiCorp Sentinel and Open Policy Agent (OPA) let teams encode compliance rules in CI/CD pipelines. Organisations using this have reduced audit preparation time from weeks to hours.

PRACTICAL EXAMPLE

A developer deploys a container running as root. The OPA policy in the pipeline blocks the deployment with a clear error and link to the hardening guide. The fix takes 5 minutes. The compliance log records the event automatically.

REFLECTION QUESTION

How long would it take your team to produce compliance evidence for a surprise audit?